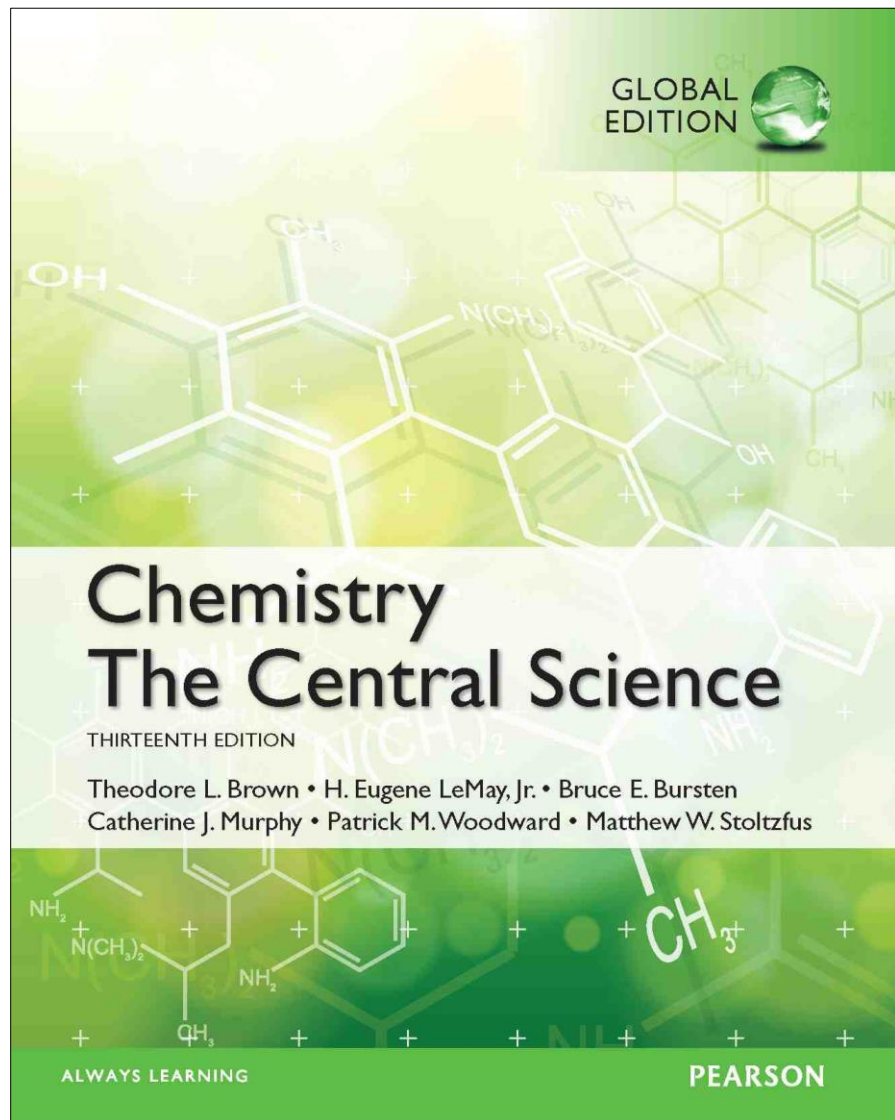




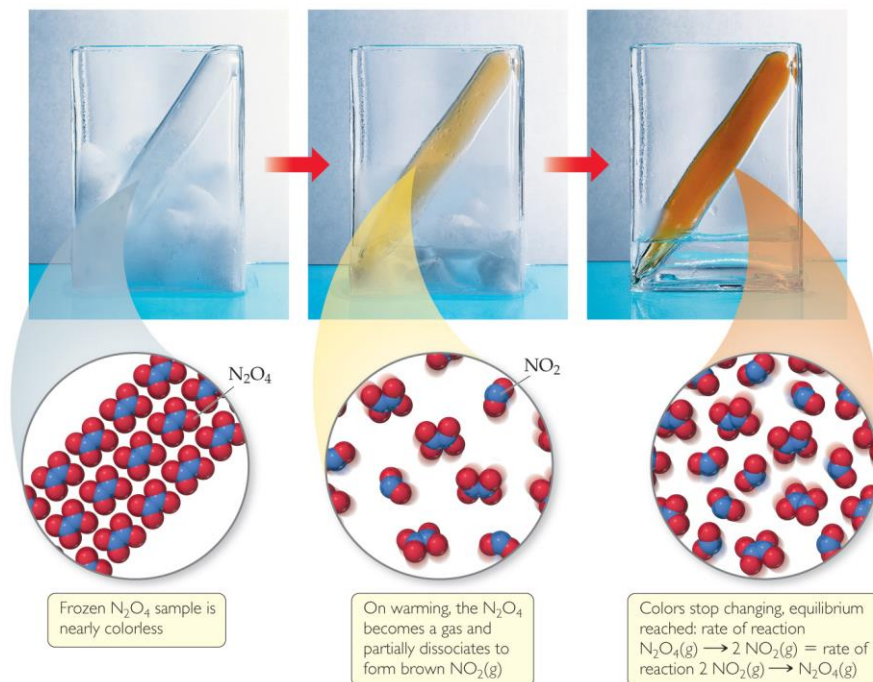
Lecture Presentation

Chapter 15

Chemical Equilibrium

James F. Kirby
Quinnipiac University
Hamden, CT

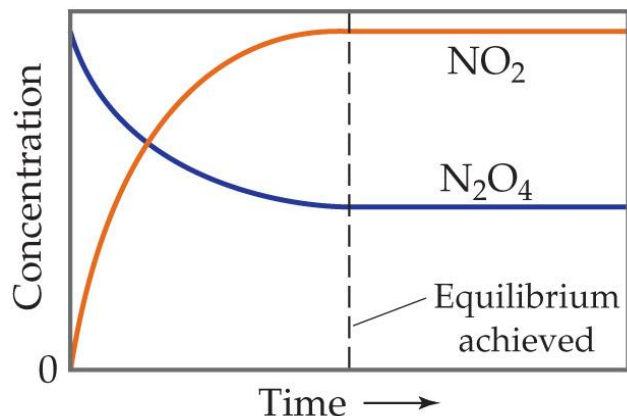
The Concept of Equilibrium



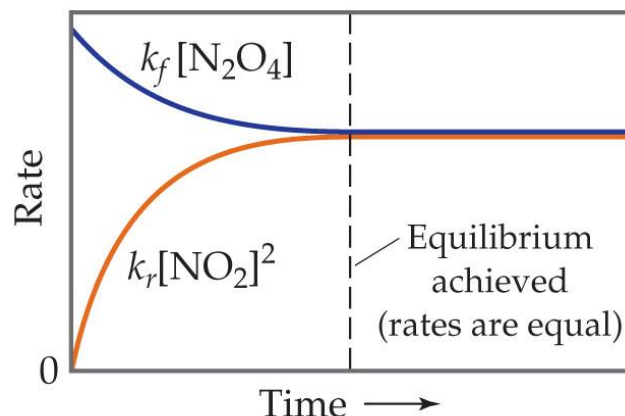
Chemical equilibrium occurs when a reaction and its reverse reaction proceed at the same rate. In the figure above, equilibrium is finally reached in the third picture.



The Concept of Equilibrium



(a)



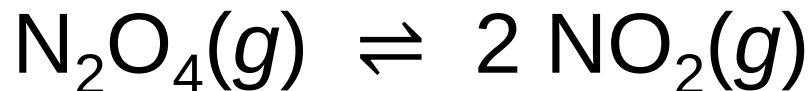
(b)

- As a system approaches equilibrium, both the forward and reverse reactions are occurring.
- At equilibrium, the forward and reverse reactions are proceeding *at the same rate* – **DYNAMIC !**
- Once equilibrium is achieved, the *amount* of each reactant and product remains constant.



Writing the Equation for an Equilibrium Reaction

Since, in a system at equilibrium, both the forward and reverse reactions are being carried out, we write its equation with a double arrow:



Comparing Rates

- For the forward reaction
$$\text{N}_2\text{O}_4(g) \rightarrow 2 \text{NO}_2(g)$$
- The rate law is
$$\text{Rate} = k_f[\text{N}_2\text{O}_4]$$
- For the reverse reaction
$$2 \text{NO}_2(g) \rightarrow \text{N}_2\text{O}_4(g)$$
- The rate law is
$$\text{Rate} = k_r[\text{NO}_2]^2$$



The Meaning of Equilibrium

- Therefore, at equilibrium

$$\text{Rate}_f = \text{Rate}_r$$

$$k_f[\text{N}_2\text{O}_4] = k_r[\text{NO}_2]^2$$

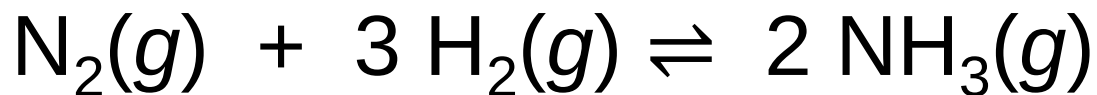
- Rewriting this, it becomes the expression for the equilibrium constant, K_{eq} .

$$\frac{[\text{NO}_2]^2}{[\text{N}_2\text{O}_4]} = \frac{k_f}{k_r} = \text{a constant}$$



Another Equilibrium— The Haber Process

- Consider the Haber Process, which is the industrial preparation of ammonia:



- The equilibrium constant depends on stoichiometry:

$$K_c = \frac{[\text{NH}_3]^2}{[\text{N}_2][\text{H}_2]^3}$$



The Equilibrium Constant

- Consider the generalized reaction
$$a A + b B \rightleftharpoons d D + e E$$
- The equilibrium expression for this reaction would be

$$K_c = \frac{[D]^d[E]^e}{[A]^a[B]^b}$$

← products
← reactants

- Also, since **pressure** is proportional to **concentration** for gases in a closed system, the equilibrium expression can also be written

$$K_p = \frac{(P_D)^d(P_E)^e}{(P_A)^a(P_B)^b}$$



More with Gases and Equilibrium

- We can compare the equilibrium constant based on concentration to the one based on pressure.
- For gases, $PV = nRT$ (the Ideal Gas Law).
- Rearranging, $P = (n/V)RT$; (n/V) is [].
- The result is

$$K_p = K_c(RT)^{\Delta n}$$

- where

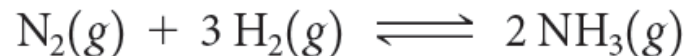
$$\Delta n = (\text{moles of gaseous product}) - (\text{moles of gaseous reactant})$$



SAMPLE EXERCISE 15.2

Converting between K_c and K_p

For the Haber process,



$K_c = 9.60$ at 300°C . Calculate K_p for this reaction at this temperature.

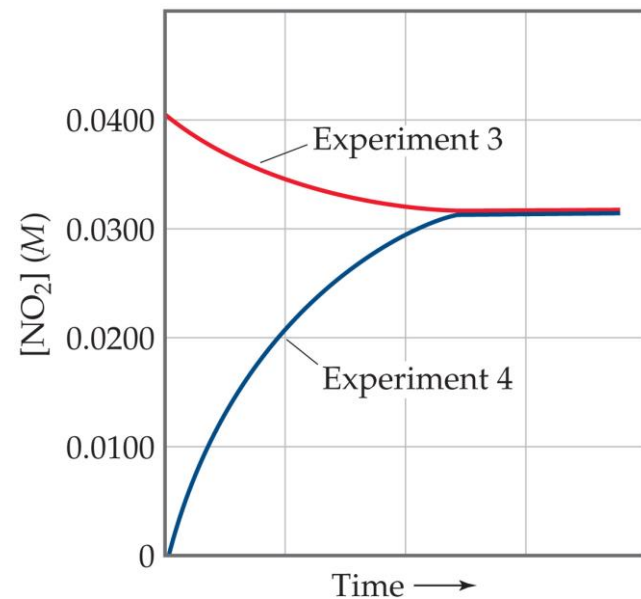


Equilibrium Can Be Reached from Either Direction

- As you can see, the ratio of $[\text{NO}_2]^2$ to $[\text{N}_2\text{O}_4]$ remains constant at this temperature no matter what the initial concentrations of NO_2 and N_2O_4 are.

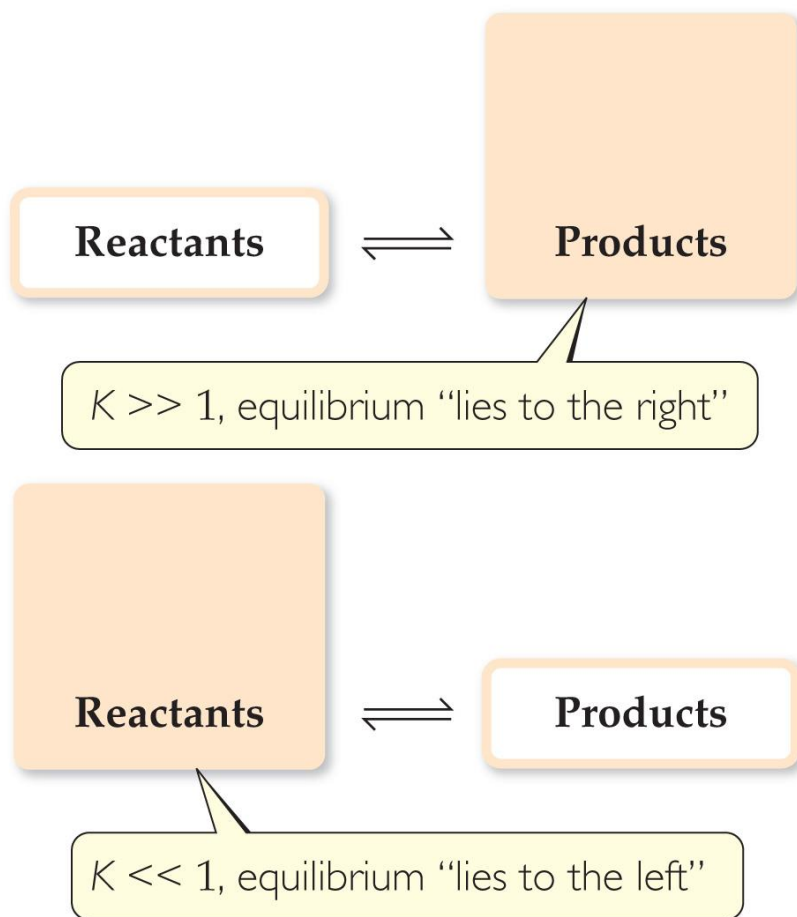
Table 15.1 Initial and Equilibrium Concentrations of $\text{N}_2\text{O}_4(g)$ and $\text{NO}_2(g)$ at 100°C

Experiment	Initial $[\text{N}_2\text{O}_4]$ (M)	Initial $[\text{NO}_2]$ (M)	Equilibrium $[\text{N}_2\text{O}_4]$ (M)	Equilibrium $[\text{NO}_2]$ (M)	K_c
1	0.0	0.0200	0.00140	0.0172	0.211
2	0.0	0.0300	0.00280	0.0243	0.211
3	0.0	0.0400	0.00452	0.0310	0.213
4	0.0200	0.0	0.00452	0.0310	0.213



Equilibrium

Magnitude of K

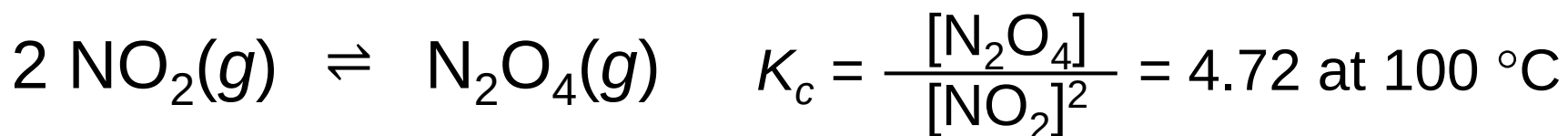
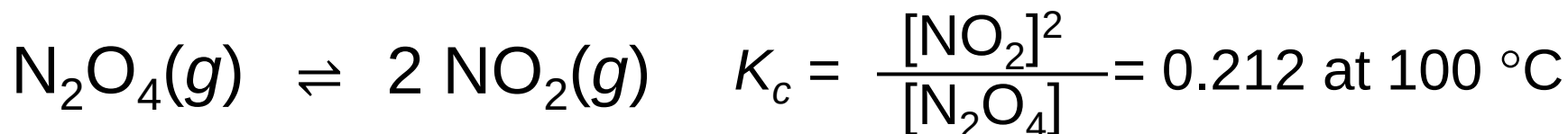


- If $K \gg 1$, the reaction favors products; products predominate at equilibrium.
- If $K \ll 1$, the reaction favors reactants; reactants predominate at equilibrium.



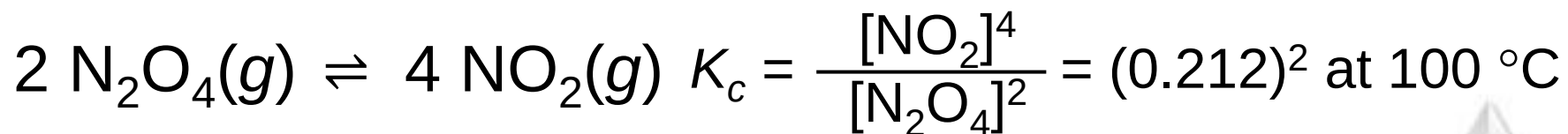
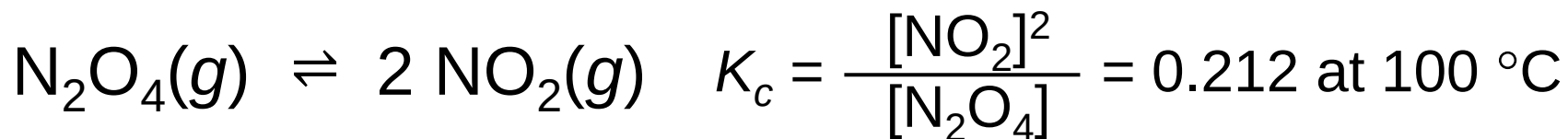
The Direction of the Chemical Equation and K

The equilibrium constant of a reaction in the reverse reaction is the reciprocal of the equilibrium constant of the forward reaction:



Stoichiometry and Equilibrium Constants

To find the new equilibrium constant of a reaction when the equation has been multiplied by a number, simply raise the original equilibrium constant to that power. Here, the stoichiometry is doubled; the constant is the squared!



Equilibrium



$$K_c' = K_c \times K_c$$

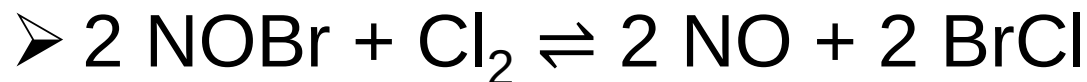
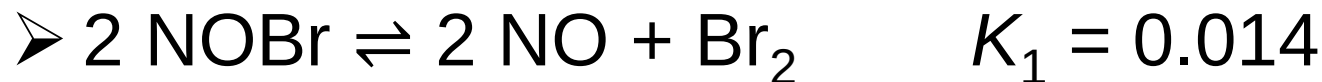


Consecutive Equilibria

- When two consecutive equilibria occur, the equations can be added to give a single equilibrium.
- The equilibrium constant of the new reaction is the *product* of the two constants:

$$K_3 = K_1 \times K_2$$

- Example



$$K_3 = K_1 \times K_2 = 0.014 \times 7.2 = 0.10$$

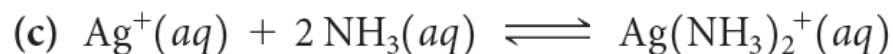
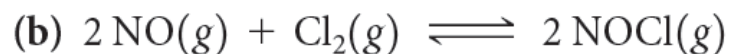
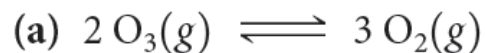


SAMPLE

EXERCISE 15.1

Writing Equilibrium-Constant Expressions

Write the equilibrium expression for K_c for the following reactions:

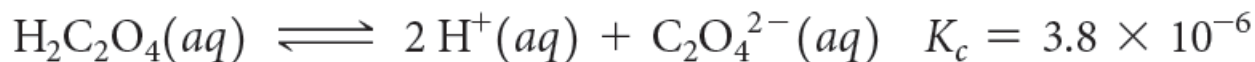
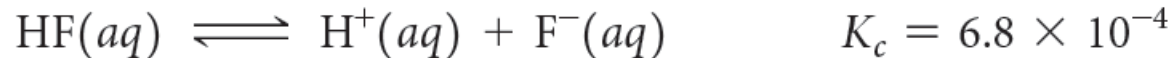


SAMPLE

EXERCISE 15.4

Combining Equilibrium Expressions

Given the reactions



determine the value of K_c for the reaction



Homogeneous vs. Heterogeneous

- **Homogeneous equilibria** occur when all reactants and products are in the same phase.
- **Heterogeneous equilibria** occur when something in the equilibrium is in a different phase.
- The value used for the concentration of a pure substance is always 1.



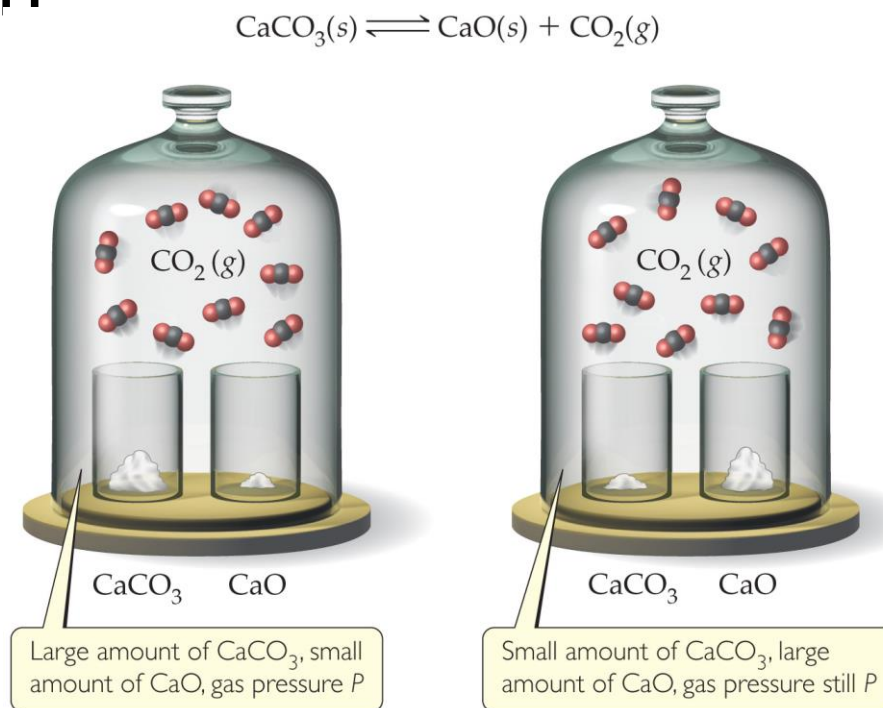
The Decomposition of CaCO_3 — A Heterogeneous Equilibrium

- The equation for the reaction is
$$\text{CaCO}_3(\text{s}) \rightleftharpoons \text{CaO}(\text{s}) + \text{CO}_2(\text{g})$$
- This results in

$$K_c = [\text{CO}_2]$$

and

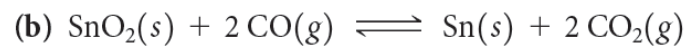
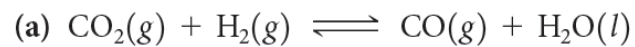
$$K_p = P_{\text{CO}_2}$$



**SAMPLE
EXERCISE 15.5**

Writing Equilibrium-Constant Expressions for Heterogeneous Reactions

Write the equilibrium-constant expression K_c for



Deducing Equilibrium Concentrations

ICE approach

I - Initial Concentration(s)

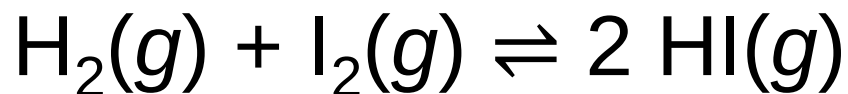
C - Change in Concentration(s) when equilibrium is reached in comparison to the initial concentration(s)

E – Concentrations at **E**quilibrium



An Example

A closed system initially containing $1.000 \times 10^{-3} \text{ M H}_2$ and $2.000 \times 10^{-3} \text{ M I}_2$ at 448°C is allowed to reach equilibrium. Analysis of the equilibrium mixture shows that the concentration of HI is $1.87 \times 10^{-3} \text{ M}$. Calculate K_c at 448°C for the reaction taking place, which is



What Do We Know?

	$[\text{H}_2], M$	$[\text{I}_2], M$	$[\text{HI}], M$
Initial Concentration	1.000×10^{-3}	2.000×10^{-3}	0
Change in Concentration	$- (1/2) 1.87 \times 10^{-3}$	$- (1/2) 1.87 \times 10^{-3}$	$+ 1.87 \times 10^{-3}$
Concentration at Equilibrium	$(1.000 - 0.935) \times 10^{-3}$ $= 0.065 \times 10^{-3}$	$(2.000 - 0.935) \times 10^{-3}$ $= 1.065 \times 10^{-3}$	1.87×10^{-3}



And, therefore, the equilibrium constant...

$$\begin{aligned}K_c &= \frac{[\text{HI}]^2}{[\text{H}_2] [\text{I}_2]} \\&= \frac{(1.87 \times 10^{-3})^2}{(6.5 \times 10^{-5})(1.065 \times 10^{-3})} \\&= 51\end{aligned}$$

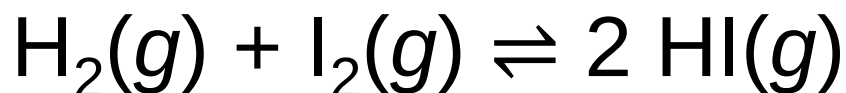


Calculating Equilibrium Concentrations (using the same ICE approach)

If you know the equilibrium constant, you can find equilibrium concentrations from initial concentrations and changes (based on stoichiometry).



A 1.000 L flask is filled with 1.000 mol of $\text{H}_2(g)$ and 2.000 mol of $\text{I}_2(g)$ at 448 °C. Given a K_c of 50.5 at 448 °C, what are the equilibrium concentrations of H_2 , I_2 , and HI ?



initial concentration (M)	1.000	2.000	0
change in concentration (M)	-x	-x	+2x
equilibrium concentration (M)	1.000 - x	2.000 - x	2x

- Set up the equilibrium constant expression, filling in equilibrium concentrations from the table.

$$K_c = \frac{[\text{HI}]^2}{[\text{H}_2][\text{I}_2]} = \frac{(2x)^2}{(1.000 - x)(2.000 - x)} = 50.5$$

- Solving for x is done using the quadratic formula, resulting in $x = 2.323$ or 0.935 .



Since x must be subtracted from 1.000 M , 2.323 makes no physical sense. (It results in a negative concentration!) **The value must be 0.935 .**

So

- $[\text{H}_2]_{\text{eq}} = 1.000 - 0.935 = 0.065\text{ M}$
- $[\text{I}_2]_{\text{eq}} = 2.000 - 0.935 = 1.065\text{ M}$
- $[\text{HI}]_{\text{eq}} = 2(0.935) = 1.87\text{ M}$

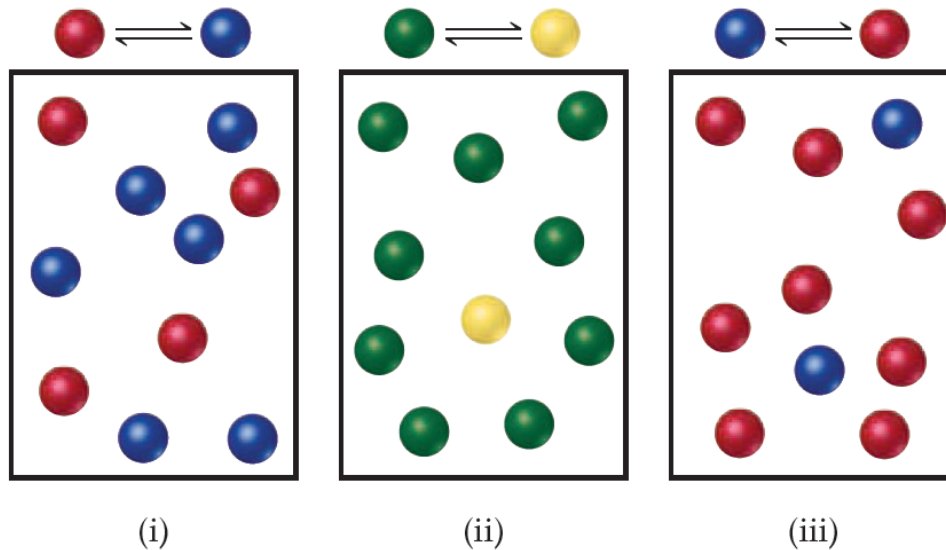


SAMPLE EXERCISE 15.3

Interpreting the Magnitude of an Equilibrium Constant

The following diagrams represent three systems at equilibrium, all in the same-size containers.

(a) Without doing any calculations, rank the systems in order of increasing K_c . (b) If the volume of the containers is 1.0 L and each sphere represents 0.10 mol, calculate K_c for each system.



Is a Mixture in Equilibrium?

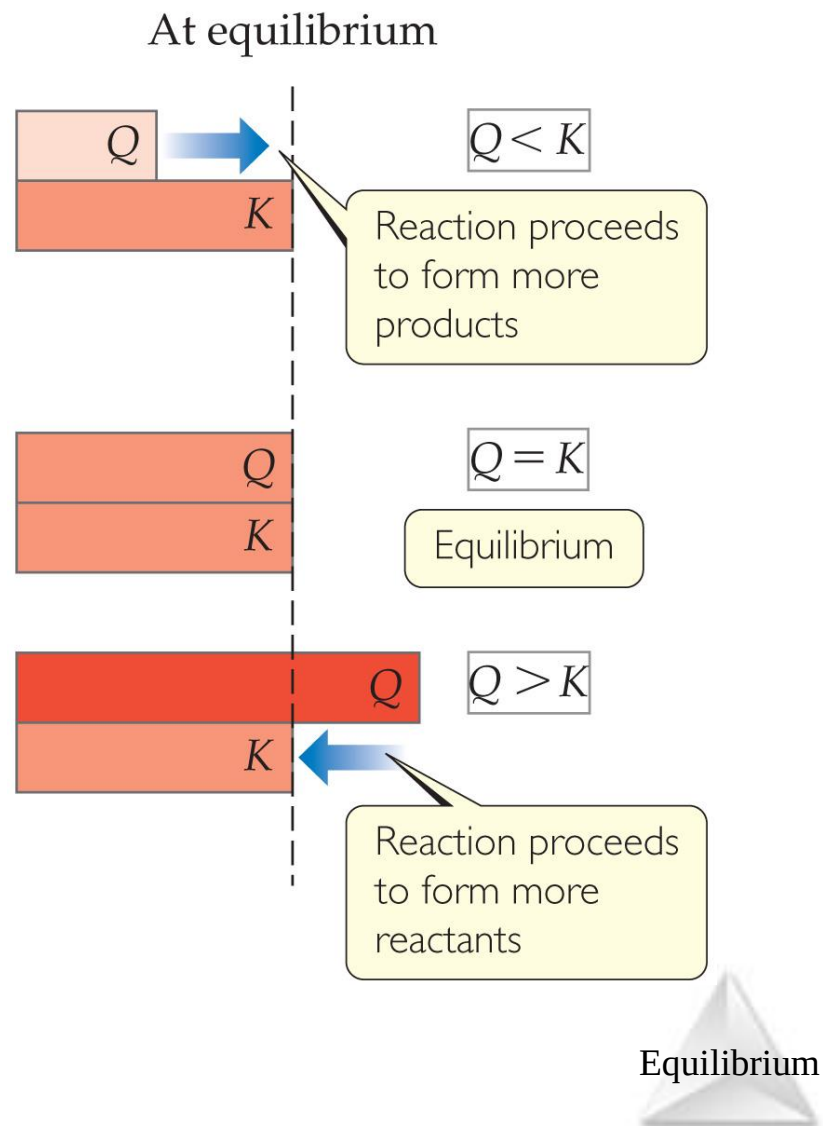
Which Way Does the Reaction Go?

- To answer these questions, we calculate the **reaction quotient**, Q .
- Q looks like the equilibrium constant, K , but the values used to calculate it are the **current** conditions, **not necessarily** those for equilibrium.
- To calculate Q , one substitutes the initial concentrations of reactants and products into the equilibrium expression.



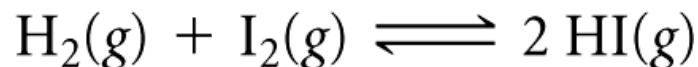
Comparing Q and K

- Nature wants $Q = K$.
- If $Q < K$, nature will make the reaction proceed to products.
- If $Q = K$, the reaction is in equilibrium.
- If $Q > K$, nature will make the reaction proceed to reactants.



Exercise Predicting the Direction of Approach to Equilibrium

At 448 °C the equilibrium constant K_c for the reaction

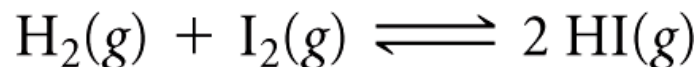


is 50.5. Predict in which direction the reaction proceeds to reach equilibrium if we start with 2.0×10^{-2} mol of HI, 1.0×10^{-2} mol of H_2 , and 3.0×10^{-2} of I_2 in a 2.00-L container.



Exercise Predicting the Direction of Approach to Equilibrium

At 448 °C the equilibrium constant K_c for the reaction



is 50.5. Predict in which direction the reaction proceeds to reach equilibrium if we start with 2.0×10^{-2} mol of HI, 1.0×10^{-2} mol of H_2 , and 3.0×10^{-2} of I_2 in a 2.00-L container.

Solution

The **current** concentrations are

$$[\text{HI}] = 2.0 \times 10^{-2} \text{ mol}/2.00 \text{ L} = 1.0 \times 10^{-2} \text{ M}$$
$$[\text{H}_2] = 1.0 \times 10^{-2} \text{ mol}/2.00 \text{ L} = 5.0 \times 10^{-3} \text{ M}$$
$$[\text{I}_2] = 3.0 \times 10^{-2} \text{ mol}/2.00 \text{ L} = 1.5 \times 10^{-2} \text{ M}$$

The reaction **quotient** is therefore

$$Q_c = \frac{[\text{HI}]^2}{[\text{H}_2][\text{I}_2]} = \frac{(1.0 \times 10^{-2})^2}{(5.0 \times 10^{-3})(1.5 \times 10^{-2})} = 1.3$$

Because $Q_c < K_c$, the concentration of HI must increase and the concentrations of H_2 and I_2 must decrease to reach equilibrium; the reaction as written proceeds left to right to attain equilibrium.

Equilibrium

Le Châtelier's Principle



Henri-Louis Le Châtelier (1850–1936)



Le Châtelier's Principle

“If a system at equilibrium is **disturbed by a change** in temperature, pressure (volume), or the concentration of one of the components, the system will shift its equilibrium position so as to **counteract (offset) the effect** of the disturbance.”



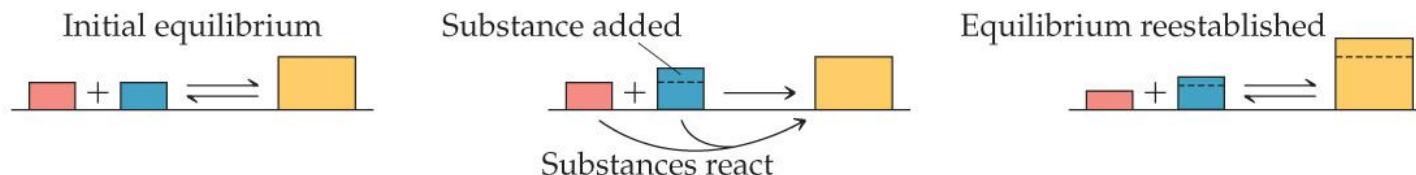
Using LeChâtelier's Principle **qualitatively** to predict shifts in equilibrium based on changes in conditions.

Le Châtelier's Principle

If a system at equilibrium is disturbed by a change in **concentration**, **pressure**, or **temperature**, the system will shift its equilibrium position so as to counter the effect of the disturbance.

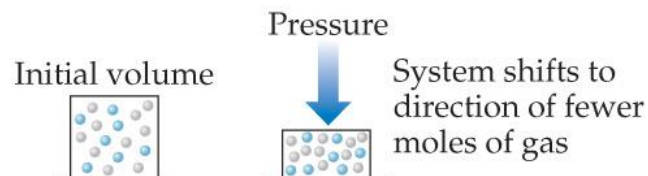
Concentration: adding or removing a reactant or product

If a substance is added to a system at equilibrium, the system reacts to consume some of the substance. If a substance is removed from a system, the system reacts to produce more of substance.



Pressure: changing the pressure by changing the volume

At constant temperature, reducing the volume of a gaseous equilibrium mixture causes the system to shift in the direction that reduces the number of moles of gas.



Temperature:

If the temperature of a system at equilibrium is increased, the system reacts as if we added a reactant to an endothermic reaction or a product to an exothermic reaction. The equilibrium shifts in the direction that consumes the "excess reactant," namely heat.



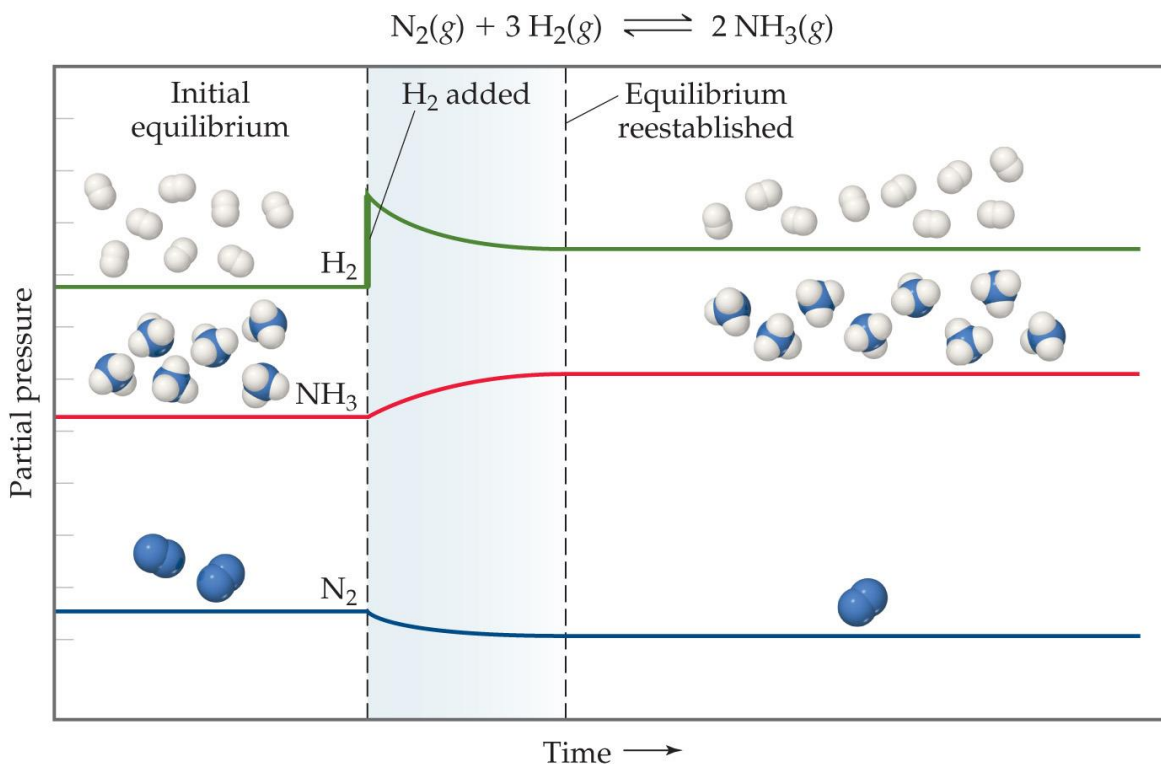
Equilibrium

Change in Reactant or Product Concentration

- If the system is in equilibrium

adding a reaction component will result in some of it being used up.

removing a reaction component will result in some of it being produced.



Equilibrium

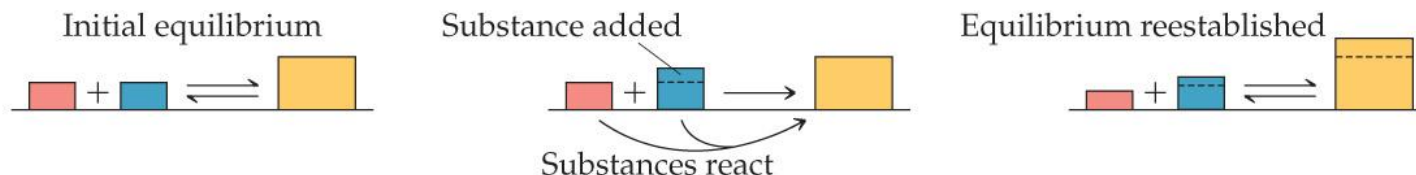
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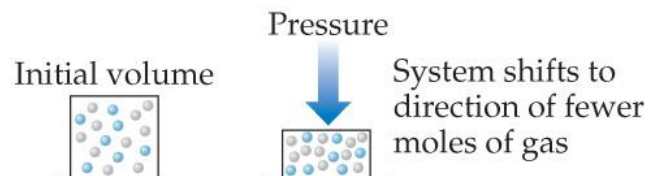
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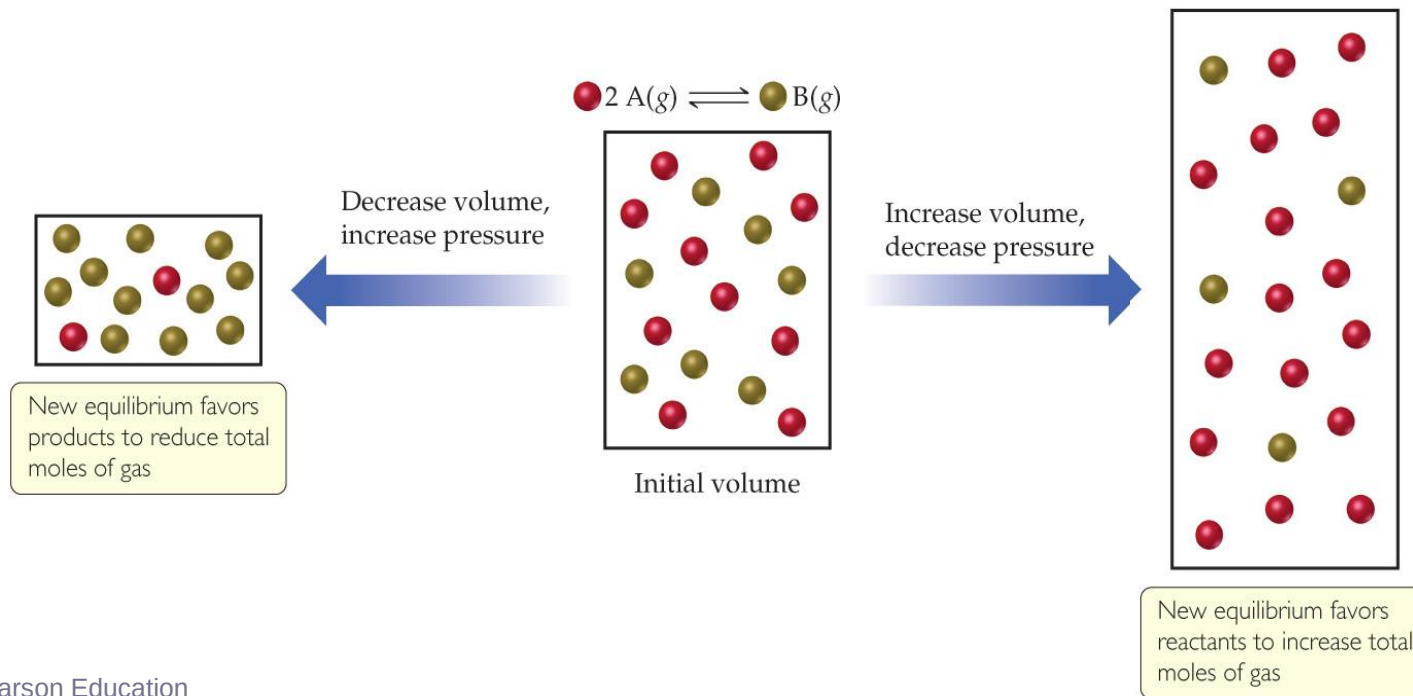
If the temperature of a system at equilibrium is increased, the system reacts as if we added a reactant to an endothermic reaction or a product to an exothermic reaction. The equilibrium shifts in the direction that consumes the "excess reactant," namely heat.



Equilibrium

Change in Volume or Pressure

- When gases are involved in an equilibrium, a change in pressure or volume will affect equilibrium:
 - Higher volume or lower pressure favors the side of the equation with more moles (and vice-versa).



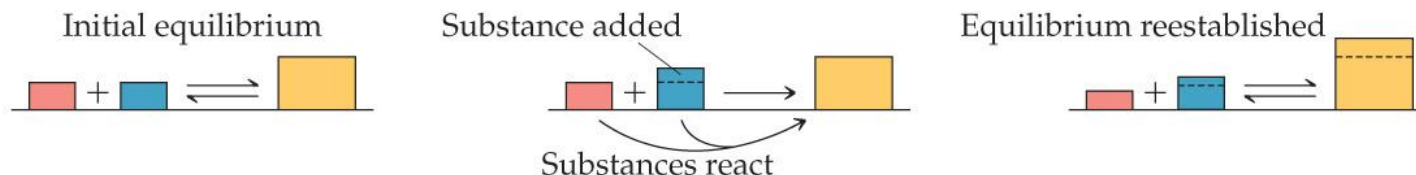
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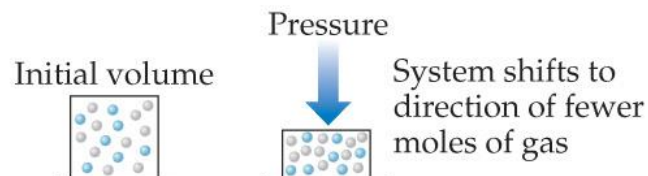
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Temperature:

If the temperature of a system at equilibrium is increased, the system reacts as if we added a reactant to an endothermic reaction or a product to an exothermic reaction. The equilibrium shifts in the direction that consumes the "excess reactant," namely heat.



Equilibrium

Change in Temperature

- Is the reaction **endothermic** or **exothermic** as written? That matters!
- **Exothermic**: Heat acts *like* a product; adding heat drives a reaction toward reactants.

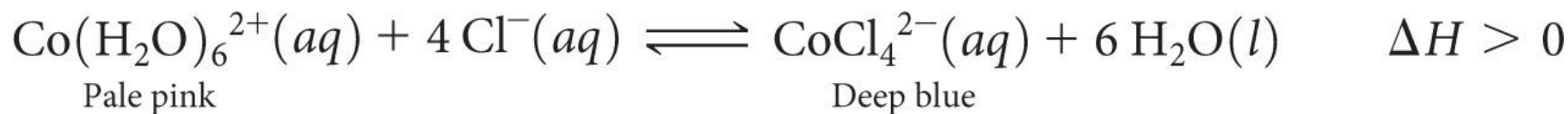
Reactants → Products + heat

- **Endothermic**: Heat acts *like* a reactant; adding heat drives a reaction toward products.

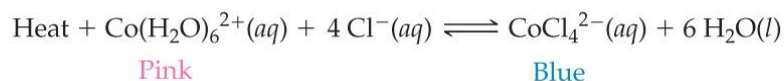
Reactants + heat → Products



An Endothermic Equilibrium



$\Delta H > 0$, endothermic reaction

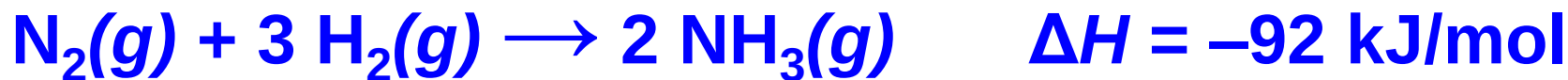


The diagram illustrates the endothermic equilibrium between two cobalt complexes in response to temperature changes. It features three beakers connected by arrows indicating the direction of the shift.

- Left Beaker (Cooling):** A blue arrow labeled "Cool" points from the middle beaker to this one. The solution is pink. A circular inset shows a high concentration of pink $\text{Co}(\text{H}_2\text{O})_6^{2+}$ ions (each with a central blue sphere and six red spheres) and a low concentration of blue CoCl_4^{2-} ions (each with a central blue sphere and four red spheres). A text box below states: "Solution appears pink because lowering the temperature shifts the equilibrium to favor formation of the pink $\text{Co}(\text{H}_2\text{O})_6^{2+}$ ion."
- Middle Beaker (Equilibrium):** The solution is violet. A circular inset shows a mixture of pink $\text{Co}(\text{H}_2\text{O})_6^{2+}$ ions and blue CoCl_4^{2-} ions. A text box below states: "Solution appears violet because appreciable amounts of both pink $\text{Co}(\text{H}_2\text{O})_6^{2+}$ and blue CoCl_4^{2-} are present."
- Right Beaker (Heating):** A red arrow labeled "Heat" points from the middle beaker to this one. The solution is blue. A circular inset shows a high concentration of blue CoCl_4^{2-} ions and a low concentration of pink $\text{Co}(\text{H}_2\text{O})_6^{2+}$ ions. A text box below states: "Solution appears blue because raising the temperature shifts the equilibrium to favor formation of the blue CoCl_4^{2-} ion."

Equilibrium

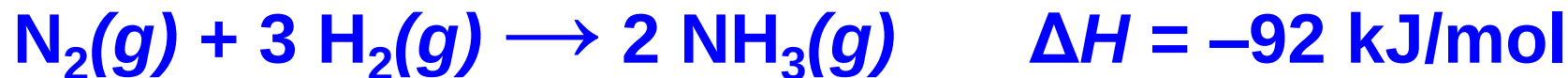
An Exothermic Equilibrium



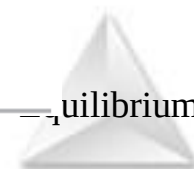
- The Haber Process for producing ammonia from the elements is **exothermic**.
- One would think that cooling down the reactants would result in more product (larger K_{eq}) but slower reaction (smaller k).
- The activation energy for this reaction is high!
- This is the *one* instance where a system in equilibrium can be affected by a **catalyst**!



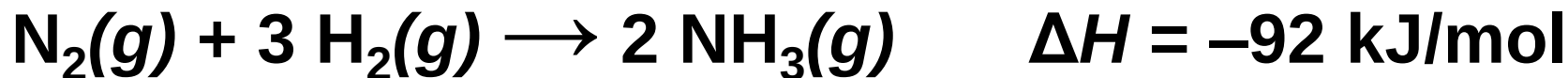
Changes in Temperature



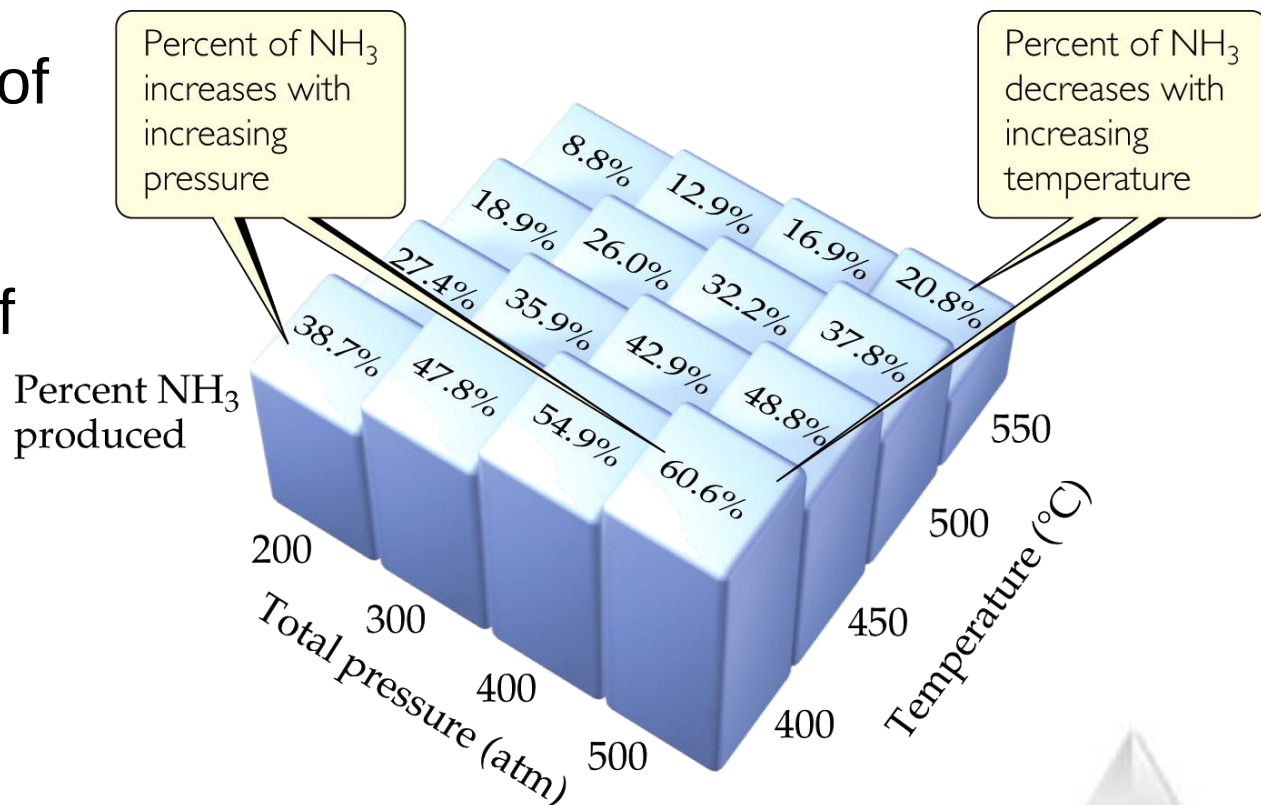
Temperature (°C)	K_p
300	4.34×10^{-3}
400	1.64×10^{-4}
450	4.51×10^{-5}
500	1.45×10^{-5}
550	5.38×10^{-6}
600	2.25×10^{-6}



The Haber Process



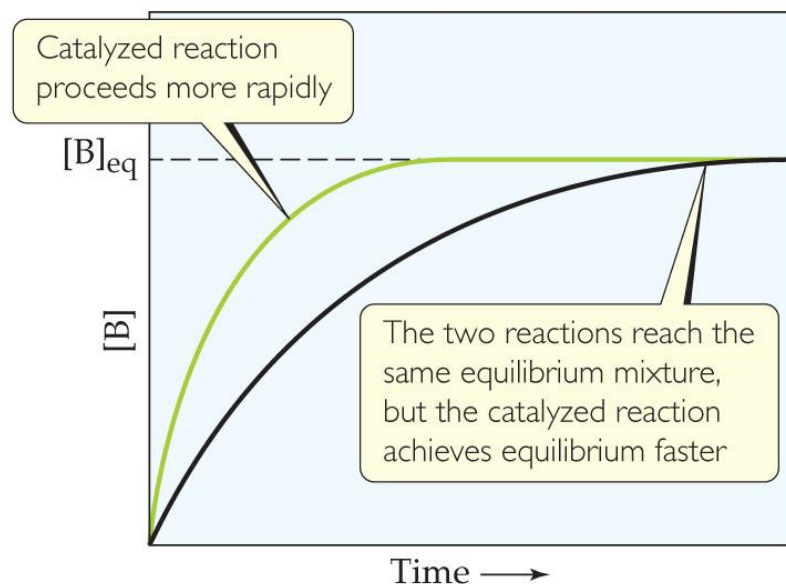
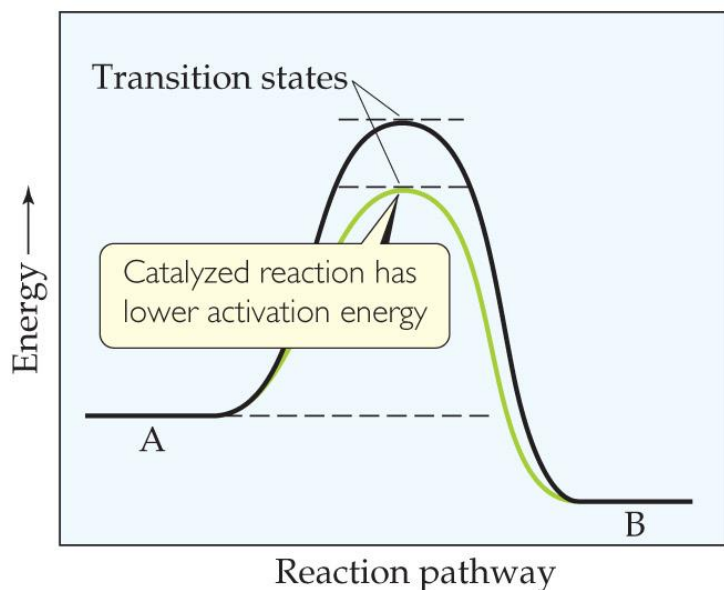
The transformation of nitrogen and hydrogen into ammonia (NH_3) is of tremendous significance in agriculture, where ammonia-based fertilizers are of utmost importance.



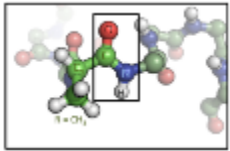
Equilibrium

Catalysts

- **Catalysts** increase the rate of both the forward *and* reverse reactions.
- Equilibrium is achieved faster, but the **equilibrium composition remains unaltered**.
- Activation energy is lowered, allowing equilibrium to be established at lower temperatures.



equilibrium



Protein 蛋白质

空气中含有
78%氮气N₂

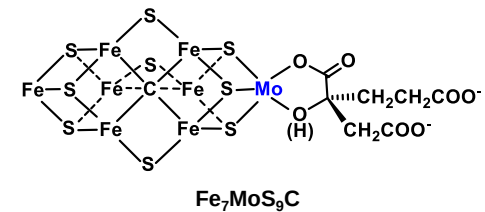
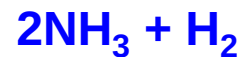
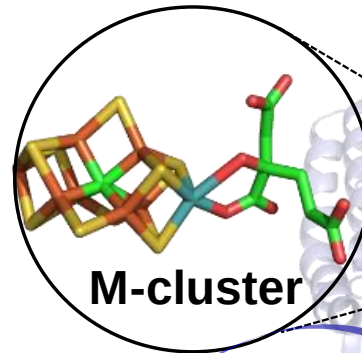
78% N₂ in air



根瘤菌 (Rhizobia)

nitrogenase

固氮酶



Equilibrium



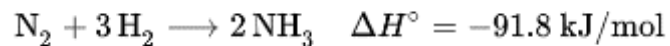
一亩大豆固氮约 8kg/year



大豆玉米复合种植
bean and corn

人工合成氨

Haber-Bosch process



230 million tonnes per year

Equilibrium



Haber–Bosch process

**Nobel Prize in chemistry
(1918)**



**Fritz Haber
(1868-1934)**

**Nobel Prize in chemistry
(1931)**



**Carl Bosch
(1874-1940)**

**Nobel Prize in chemistry
(2007)**



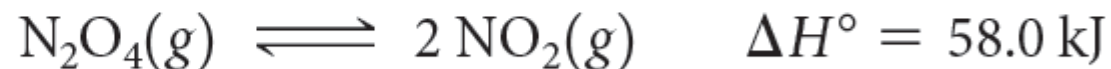
**Gerhard Ertl
(1936-)**



Le Châtelier's Principle

System	Change	Result
$\text{CO}_2 + \text{H}_2 \rightarrow \text{H}_2\text{O}(g) + \text{CO}$	A drying agent is added to absorb H_2O	Shift to the right. Continuous removal of a product will force any reaction to the right
$\text{H}_2(g) + \text{I}_2(g) \rightarrow 2\text{HI}(g)$	Some nitrogen gas is added	No change; N_2 is not a component of this reaction system.
$\text{NaCl}(s) + \text{H}_2\text{SO}_4(l) \rightarrow \text{Na}_2\text{SO}_4(s) + \text{HCl}(g)$	Reaction is carried out in an open container	Because HCl is a gas that can escape from the system, the reaction is forced to the right . This is the basis for the commercial production of hydrochloric acid.
$\text{H}_2\text{O}(l) \rightarrow \text{H}_2\text{O}(g)$	Water evaporates from an open container	Continuous removal of water vapor forces the reaction to the right , so equilibrium is never achieved.
$\text{HCN}(aq) \rightarrow \text{H}^+(aq) + \text{CN}^-(aq)$	The solution is diluted	Shift to right ; the product $[\text{H}^+][\text{CN}^-]$ diminishes more rapidly than does $[\text{HCN}]$.
$\text{AgCl}(s) \rightarrow \text{Ag}^+(aq) + \text{Cl}^-(aq)$	Some NaCl is added to the solution	Shift to left due to increase in Cl^- concentration. This is known as the common ion effect on solubility.
$\text{N}_2 + 3 \text{H}_2 \rightarrow 2 \text{NH}_3$	A catalyst is added to speed up this reaction	No change. Catalysts affect only the rate of a reaction; they have no effect at all on the composition of the equilibrium state.

Consider the equilibrium



In which direction will the equilibrium shift when **(a)** N_2O_4 is added, **(b)** NO_2 is removed, **(c)** the pressure is increased by addition of $\text{N}_2(g)$, **(d)** the volume is increased, **(e)** the temperature is decreased?





GIVE IT SOME THOUGHT

Use Le Châtelier's principle to explain why the equilibrium vapor pressure of a liquid increases with increasing temperature.

- A. Evaporation is an exothermic process and an increasing temperature shifts the equilibrium $\text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{l}) \rightleftharpoons \text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{g})$ to the right and increases the equilibrium vapor pressure.
- B.

 Evaporation is an endothermic process and an increasing temperature shifts the equilibrium $\text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{l}) \rightleftharpoons \text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{g})$ to the right and increases the equilibrium vapor pressure.
- C. Evaporation is an exothermic process and an increasing temperature shifts the equilibrium $\text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{l}) \rightleftharpoons \text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{g})$ to the left and increases the equilibrium vapor pressure.
- D. Evaporation is an endothermic process and an increasing temperature shifts the equilibrium $\text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{l}) \rightleftharpoons \text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{g})$ to the left and increases the equilibrium vapor pressure.

At equilibrium, the rate of the forward reaction is _____ the rate of the reverse reaction.

- ☒ a. equal to
- b. slower than
- c. faster than
- d. the reverse of



The reaction quotient Q is usually represented by

a. $[\text{reactants}] / [\text{products}]$.

b. $[\text{products}] / [\text{reactants}]$.

c. $[\text{reactants}] \times [\text{products}]$.

d. $[\text{reactants}] + [\text{products}]$.



If the value of the equilibrium constant is large, then _____ will mostly be present at equilibrium.

- a. reactants
- ☒ b. products
- c. catalysts
- d. shrapnel



If the value of the equilibrium constant is small, then _____ will mostly be present at equilibrium.

- ☒ a. reactants
- b. products
- c. catalysts
- d. shrapnel



Q = the reaction quotient

K = the equilibrium constant

At equilibrium, which is true?

a. $Q > K$

b. $Q < K$

☒ c. $Q = K$

d. $Q^2 = K$



Equilibrium constants typically have units of

a. M.

b. M^2 .

c. M^{1-} .

☒ d. None of the above



Reaction quotients for heterogeneous equilibria do not include concentrations of

- a. pure liquids.
- b. pure solids.
- ☒ c. Both of the above
- d. Neither of the above





$[\text{HA}] = 1.65 \times 10^{-2} \text{ M}$ and

$[\text{H}^+] = [\text{A}^-] = 5.44 \times 10^{-4} \text{ M}$ at
equilibrium. $K_c = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.

a. 1.79×10^{-2}

b. 1.79×10^{-3}

c. 1.79×10^{-4}

☒ d. 1.79×10^{-5}

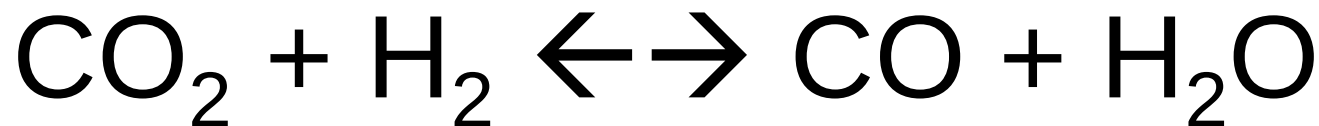


$K_P = K_C$ when

- a. the reaction is at equilibrium.
- b. the reaction is exothermic.
- c. all of the gases present are at the same pressure.
- d.

 the number of moles of gas on both sides of the balanced equation is the same.

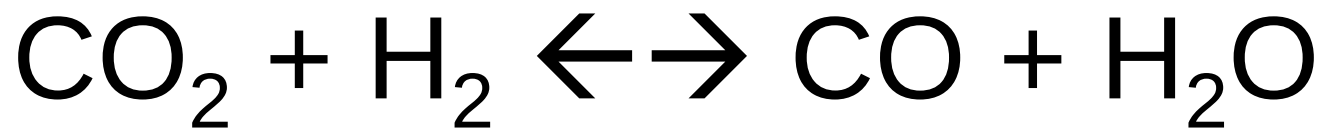




If all species are gases and H_2 is added, the concentration of CO at equilibrium will

- ☒ a. increase.
- ☐ b. decrease.
- ☐ c. remain unchanged.
- ☐ d. disappear.

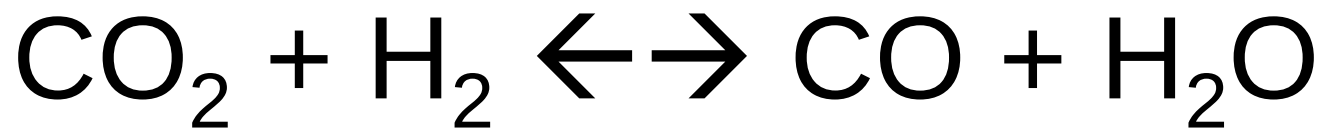




If all species are gases and H_2O is added, the equilibrium concentration of CO

- a. will increase.
- ☒ b. will decrease.
- c. will remain unchanged.
- d. will disappear.

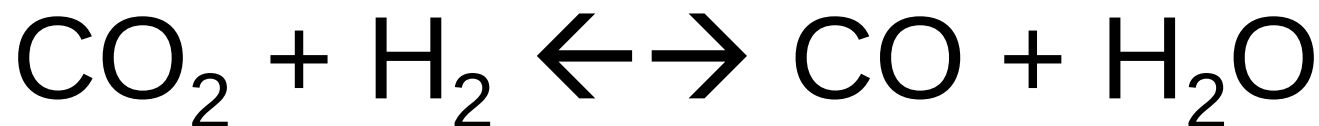




If all species are gases and CO_2 is removed, the $[\text{CO}]$ at equilibrium will

- a. increase.
- ☒ b. decrease.
- c. remain unchanged.
- d. disappear.

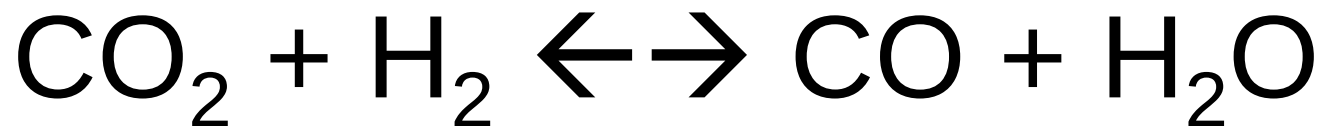




Increasing the temperature of this endothermic reaction will _____ [CO] at equilibrium.

- ☒ a. increase
- b. decrease
- c. not change
- d. eradicate

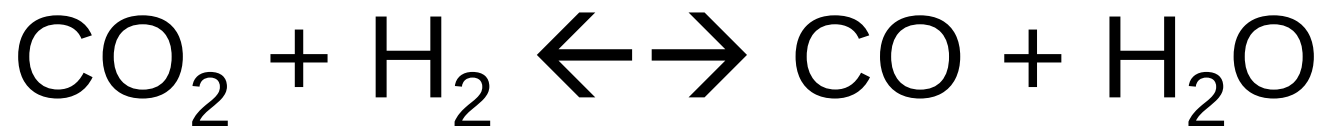




If all species are gases and the container is compressed, the amount of CO will

- a. increase.
- b. decrease.
- ☒ c. remain unchanged.
- d. vanish.





Adding a catalyst to this reaction will cause the [CO] at equilibrium to

- a. increase.
- b. decrease.
- ☒ c. remain unchanged.
- d. cease to exist.

